Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Losing Resources/Clothing etc.

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Inability to keep belongings safe		This child may have come from a chaotic household where it was impossible to keep one's belongings safe. The child may be losing resources or items of clothing because she carries them around with her and then forgets where she has left them. She may be trying to keep things with her for security – they may remind her of her current placement and these items help her to know that she will be remaining there. Alternatively, she may have memories of loss and be trying to insure against this happening again.	Support is the key here – this child has missed out on the external modulator. She needs an adult to guide her as one would a toddler. Verbalise understanding of this difficulty, *"I know how hard it is for you to look after your bag/book/pencils and to remember to put them away in the correct place. Let's see how we can support you with this."*	Organisation of materials	Practical support e.g. providing a transparent pencil case with named pencils. Reminders at the end of lesson to put all pencils in the case, including a reminder to look under the desk and to put the case away in the designated place. Ensuring the child has a place for everything. Storage boxes are best transparent, preferably labelled in a way that the child can understand e.g. pictorially. Prompt cards, possibly pictorial and laminated so items can be ticked off each day, can support the child at home and school.
Some children will have had no guidance as to how to safeguard their personal possessions. Whole-class interventions can support this work e.g. regular desk or locker tidying sessions in a non-punitive atmosphere, teaching how to keep one's desk or locker organised. (N.B. Some children are obsessed with keeping their own resources well-organised and manage this well as they feel that it is the only area of their life over which they have full control.)					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Lying

Behaviour	*Possible trigger*	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Lying	Possibly, this child has acted in a manner that he knows is unacceptable and that will have consequences. He therefore lies in an attempt to avoid the consequences of his actions. Lying might be a 'habit' he has learned.	Survival strategy – This child may have been deprived and neglected in his early history. He may have experienced the need to lie in order to keep himself safe. Fulfilment – he may lie to compensate for what he missed in his early life. Fear – He may have experienced unpleasant reprisals in the past. Insecurity – This child may be feeling insecure because of the vulnerability of his present placement or because of his feelings of rejection and shame. A child might also lie because he lacks self worth, believing you would not like him if he told the truth. Lying gives him some control and power. Shame – He may believe he is worthless and so acts accordingly. He is likely to have been lied to by his birth parents, the abuse being reinterpreted as an 'accident'.	If you know this child has lied, do not ask him if he has or why he has. He does not know why, and is feeling increased shame that he has not managed again. Validate the child's feelings *"I know you were not telling the truth and I guess it's because you were scared about the consequence of what you did."* Sanctions need to be relevant to the 'crime', but one needs to ensure that the sanction does not further shame the child. The child needs to accept responsibility for his actions and manage the consequences. Short, concise scoldings help to reduce the shame. Avoid drawn-out investigations if at all possible.	Behaviour inhibition emotional control - delayed development so acts as a toddler might do in this situation. Self-monitoring	Discuss, agree and role-play alternative strategies for different scenarios. Help the child practise considering whether the events that lead to him lying are really big or small issues. In role-play scenarios, help the child to develop a mantra that he could say to himself when he feels he is in a difficult situation, *"Oops, I've done something wrong.* *I must try not to panic.* *It will be OK."* For shame filled children: *"Can I help you feel good enough about yourself to tell the truth?"*
Understandably, lying is considered by many to be a serious misdemeanour and it creates anxieties that this will continue into adulthood. Some worry that there could be a genetic tendency and where the lying might lead. At Family Futures, we believe that careful management of the situation can help children through this. This child cannot help what he is doing and needs the support of all the adults in his life to help him. Being sad for him rather than angry will help him to see your empathy rather than your anger. There is a tendency to feel the need to show anger for the benefit of other members of the class, but this will only accentuate the immense feeling of shame this child is experiencing. Other children will be able to accept this if it is presented as a skill this child has to learn. *"Some children struggle with adding. Some children struggle with spelling ….. struggles with saying what really happened. We're going to work on all these things together as a class."*					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Inability to 'Move on'

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Inability to 'move on' from a situation or disappointment.	Possibly an issue at playtime, a conversation, a perception of injustice, a disappointment, an argument at home etc.	Shame – anxiety about being wrong. This child may have been in an environment where she lived in a constant state of fear. She may have been blamed for her and others' actions. She may feel an overwhelming sense of responsibility for what has happened to her and others close to her and feels easily shamed when something happens at school. Need for fairness and justice – she may have experienced settings where siblings were treated differently; a need for fair shares could have been a survival strategy, hence her need for fairness in the here and now. Dissociation – a memory may have been triggered and the child dissociates in order to cope. Fear of rejection – she may worry that her actions will cause others to reject her, an experience she may well have suffered in her early life.	Validate her feelings e.g. *"I know you find it difficult to forget what has happened, especially if you feel it was unfair. Let's see if I can help you with this."* She may need a few moments with a supporting adult to express her anxieties before she can move on. If the child is disassociating a gentle hand on her shoulder (if permitted) may bring her back to the present.	Shift Emotional control Behaviour inhibition	Using a visual and interactive method may help e.g. provide easy access to a small, plastic dustbin and some pieces of paper (perhaps on the teacher's desk) so any issues can be written on a piece of paper and thrown away. Support the pupil in using this. The child may need to talk about her feelings before putting them in the bin. Provide an exercise book that the pupil can use to express her emotion and then 'leave it there'. Provide a routine to distinguish between different activities. A reminder a few minutes before an activity is due to change may help the child to prepare herself for the change.
Because of a child's issues relating to her early trauma, getting ready for school and getting out in the morning can be very difficult within the home situation. Sometimes, these children arrive at school having experienced upset at home. They may be feeling responsibility and shame for this. They may be experiencing regret and anxiety. They may be wondering if parents will still love them and be there for them. It's difficult for them to focus on school in this case but a welcoming smile, a few kind words and a responsibility or errand may help them to manage this.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Peer Problems

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
An inability to relate to peers appropriately. Unpredictable behaviours that leave peers bewildered and feeling vulnerable. Controlling behaviours that alienate peers.	Everyday scenarios with peers will lead to clashes and disagreements	The need for control – these children lost control early in their lives; they are not prepared to accept controlling behaviours from others. Fear of rejection can lead to rejecting behaviour or in contrast, they can be overbearing and can overwhelm peers by their constant and demanding attentions. Shame does not allow them to consider themselves worthy of friendships. It is difficult for others to like somebody who does not like him or herself. This child may have never been taught how to play collaboratively and needs assistance with this. This child has experienced difficulties attaching to his primary care-giver because of his early life experiences; secondary attachments need to develop after this.	It is incredibly difficult to alleviate peer problems but one can set up groupings to enable more appropriate friendships to be made. However, he may only be able to manage limited periods with his peers, and may need short sessions to 'practise' peer relationships. The teacher's acceptance of this child with all his problems, and the example of unconditional inclusion will act as a role-model for other pupils. Providing opportunities for him to succeed in relationships e.g. helping in a younger class can help others to see him in a different light.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Self-monitoring	Supporting this child to manage his impulses, and to control his emotions will improve his chances of maintaining firm friendships. Cognitive strategies and role-playing possible incidents can help. Helping him to consider his behaviour and how he could have managed a situation differently will help to develop his self-monitoring skills.
Social integration for these children is so important, but sadly incredibly difficult to achieve because of their behaviours. Often, they engage in inappropriate friendships. The peers who could become invaluable role-models may be concerned over the unpredictable behaviours and have higher self-esteem levels that prevent them from falling under the control of this child. Fellow parents can influence their children's acceptance of others. This inability to keep friends or inappropriate friendships can be of particular concern for parents and the idea that their child may be experiencing loneliness or rejection can be especially painful for them.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Playtime Aggression

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Playtime aggression	Inability to manage a perceived threat Disagreement with peers, accentuating a feeling of aloneness. Losing a game, thus losing control Not being allowed to be in control of a game Playtime beginning/ending before he feels ready.	Survival strategy – fight. This child feels he alone is responsible for keeping himself safe; others have not managed to do this in the past. He may have learnt to employ an aggressive strategy to protect himself from violence or abuse, to protect others or even to claim food. The need for control – he may have lost control early in his life; he may not be prepared to accept controlling behaviours from others. Neurobiologically, his body may be geared to produce high levels of stress-related hormones e.g. adrenaline and cortisol. Highly charged incidents allow him to release some of this.	Change environment – playtimes spent supervised in structured activity as a preventative approach rather than a sanction. Verbalise your understanding of the child's difficulties. Allow for supervised physical activity to burn off excess adrenaline and to practise playing safely.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Possibly shift	If the child is able, use a cognitive approach – role-play incidents and practise appropriate reactive behaviours. Talk about the body's physical state of anger so he can recognise the early signs and give him practical strategies to deal with this. Employ close supervision to avoid possibility of incidents leading to aggression.

You may possibly find that most instances of aggression are displayed at playtimes, lunchtimes and periods of free choice. Less-organised classroom moments, e.g. clearing-up times, movement from one room to another also heighten the likelihood for incidents to arise. This may be partly because he feels less safe in unstructured and less supervised environments. Other pupils can be wary of this child; some will purposely aggravate the situation and he can gain a reputation. This can lead to him being blamed unfairly, or it can lead him to slide into the expected behaviour more easily. Helpful strategies are adding more structure to avoid settings that allow the behaviour and providing supervision at the times he finds most difficult. The child needs to know that, with help, he can learn to be less aggressive.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Problems leaving the care-giver

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Possibly screaming and acting out. Possibly crying quietly. Possibly dissociating.	Leaving the care-giver	Insecurity – this child may well have suffered several moves within her life; she may have experienced care-givers not returning to collect her or physically being taken away from her known care-giver. Fear – this child may have been left with unsafe adults in the past. Although she may trust the teachers, the separation can still raise unpleasant memories. Control – this child knows that the care-giver will be affected by a display of temper at her seemingly abandoning her daughter. However, this child is unable to quash this need for control. It is important to monitor the quiet, seemingly non-responsive child as she may be struggling with the separation but may be dissociating as a means to protect herself.	Validation of her feelings, with empathy, *"I expect you're a bit frightened that Mum won't come back for you. That must be really hard. I know, though, that Mum will be back this afternoon, after story-time."* *"I guess you are really cross with Mum leaving you. I wonder if that's because you're not sure if she really loves you when she leaves you with other people."* Have Mum provide a photograph that the child can keep with her. Get Mum to write little notes in her packed lunch. Have a little toy from home ready in the desk, *"Mum knew you would find this difficult so she thought Teddy would help you today."*	Emotional control Behaviour inhibition Shift Self-monitor	An effective intervention is to allow the parent to bring this child in a little earlier than the rest of the class. This enables more time for an adult to focus on the child. Giving the child a special job to do can deflect her separation anxiety. Cognitive approaches, possibly using metaphor and role-play can assist behaviour inhibition. It is important not to belittle the child's feelings as this child's development may be at the level of a toddler and her feelings and reactions are very real to her. Shift can be assisted by careful preparation and routines – having an activity ready that is consistent each day.
The care-giver can become quite distraught when leaving a child who is upset and would possibly appreciate a phone call later to hear that the child has settled. You may also want to develop a leaving mantra which you and the parent can repeat to the child when mum leaves and that you can then repeat during the day. *"Mum hopes you have a good day and is really looking forward to hearing all about it when she collects you."*					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Lack of Punctuality

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Inability to arrive at school on time, to attend set meetings, clubs etc.	Possibly an issue at playtime, a conversation, a perception of injustice, a disappointment, an argument at home etc. Possibly fear of being abandoned again especially if the child had frequent moves.	Children with issues relating to attachment can 'act out' at home before coming to school. This can not only take more time but can create a sense of shame which he needs to manage before moving on. An argument at home can heighten separation anxiety. Control – he may feel a need to be in control and not to be subject to the parameters set by adults. Developmental trauma can impact on a child's sensory development. He may become over-stimulated by a busy environment and be unable to remember appointments.	Validate his feelings e.g. *"I know you find it difficult to remember to go to… Let's see if I can help you with this."* If he is dysregulated on arriving at school, give him a responsibility to allow a shift from the home situation and to raise his self-esteem.	Working Memory Shift Plan/organise Behaviour inhibition	The use of external cues can help – alarms on watches, telephones, palm-pilots. This pupil may need reminding to set these alarms; pagers and phone calls when a pupil can be personally reminded; the use of existing external cues e.g. when the lunch bell rings. It can be helpful to run through a visualisation technique with the pupil, imagining where he will be when the bell rings and what he needs to do when he hears it.

Because of a child's issues relating to early trauma, getting ready for school and getting out in the morning can be very difficult within the home situation. The pupil may be anxious as he arrives at school and a reprimand for being late may further distress him. It may be helpful for the child to arrive at school before or after his peers to help him manage any feelings around the change from the home to the school environment. This also allows parent and teacher to exchange information and will give the child an experience of adults working together to help him. Playground activity or assembly can be a very difficult time for a child who has suffered early trauma and may well increase his reluctance to attend school; it may help to feel more relaxed and able to come to school if he knows that he does not have to participate in these activities. Reducing the difficulties for the child may allow him to feel more positive about attending school, thereby reducing the likelihood of arriving late. Parents may also feel stressed and anxious about arriving at school late. They may well have had a difficult morning and fear of approbation from teachers is likely to increase their anxiety which could be communicated to the child. Understanding between parents and teachers will help to create a calm atmosphere where the child is helped to make better choices.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Sexualised behaviour

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Sexualised language, gestures, play, sexual exhibitionism, masturbation or sexualised behaviour towards others	Triggers are likely to be unknown, possibly even to the child. It could be an occasion when the child feels threatened, unsafe or feels the need to be in control. Certain language, changing for P.E., swimming etc. could act as triggers. Unmonitored internet access	This child may well have been subjected to, or witnessed some form of sexual abuse, or lived in a home where inappropriate sexual language or behaviour took place. He may use this behaviour to self-soothe.	Practical measures need to be in place to prevent risk to other children e.g. separate toilet facilities, close supervision at break times, an awareness of possible problems when changing for P.E. etc. Special consideration needs to be given to P.H.S.E. and sex education lessons. It may be best for both the child and other members of the class if the child is excused these lessons or receives extra support. Discussion with the child's care-giver is of paramount importance here.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Self-monitoring	Support with controlling impulses in general. Preventative and practical interventions. The child needs to know not only which behaviour is not acceptable but also what is. *"I noticed that you touched …inappropriately (name the behaviour) that is not OK; you can hold her hand but only if she agrees and when there is an adult there."*
Sexualised behaviour is a worry for all concerned and often constitutes a Child Protection issue. If the early life history of this child is known by the current care-givers, then it is likely that they will have informed the school of the possibility of this child exhibiting sexualised behaviour. Whether or not you have not been informed, the care-givers need to know the existence and prevalence of any behaviour. The safety of this child and other children is paramount and if children are at risk, then the relevant authorities need to be made aware of the situation. In order to provide safety, to protect themselves and to protect against allegations, adults need to ensure they themselves are not placed in vulnerable situations.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Shouting Out Answers/Comments in Class

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Shouting out inappropriately Not allowing other pupils or the teacher to have their say.	Circle times, moments when the teacher is speaking or asking questions, group working, class or group inputs, etc.	Need for control – this child may have unpleasant memories of when others controlled his life. His need for control is crucial to him. Shame – he feels an immense shadow of shame for what has happened to him and his lack of self-worth leads to a need to 'prove himself'. A fear of silence – he could have harrowing memories relating to silent or quiet environments. Some children use noise to drown out past traumatic memories that threaten to overwhelm them.	Validate the child's feelings away from the rest of the class. *"I know you find it hard not to shout out the answers. I'm really pleased you're joining in the lesson so well and want to show me how much you know."* *"I know you listen to my lessons and that you are able to answer my questions. I need to know if other pupils know the answers too; I'm going to help you to help me to do this."*	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control In some situations, planning and organising in relation to organising one's thinking and responses.	Reminding by a statement before the lesson. *"Remember we're going to try hard for you not to shout out"* or *"I wonder if you can let others show they know the answer too,"* rather than *"Don't shout out."* Using a pre-arranged signal or code-word as a reminder. This can be used by the teacher or, if the ethos of the class allows, other pupils can be supportive in this.

Other pupils may find this pupil's tendency to speak out annoying and can become resentful and critical. This will add to the child's deep sense of shame and may exacerbate the behaviour. Children like this can be over-bearing in a class situation and can be very wearing on the teacher. However, by remaining calm and by not demonstrating irritation, the teacher will exemplify acceptance of this pupil's difficulty and make it possible for his peers to assist him in controlling his outbursts by showing an empathic approach. It might be helpful to talk to the child when he is on his own about this problem, *"I understand you had a hard time when you were little and you are letting me know this by shouting out in class. Perhaps quiet times are hard for you. You might like to use your squeeze ball when you feel anxious rather than shout out."* (making sure he has a squeeze ball to use.) On entering the class remind the child that in this lesson he is practising to let other children answer questions.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Inability to Work in Silence

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Possibly disruptive – seemingly an inability to keep quiet; talking/ shouting out, making noises either vocally or with resources when the class has been asked to work in silence; dissociates – no longer focusing on task in hand.	Instructed to work in silence or an occasion naturally arises when pupils work in silence; circle times, moments when the teacher is speaking or asking questions, class or group inputs, assessments, etc.	Silence could bring back harrowing memories of unpleasant things that took place when the house was quiet. Shame – he feels an immense shadow of shame for what has happened to him and his lack of self-worth leads to a need to 'prove himself'. Silence could enable memories and worries to surface – this child needs to keep talking to disallow any unwanted thoughts to enter his head. Conversely, he may be consumed by these thoughts and therefore, unable to focus.	Adult support, validation of feelings – *"I know that working in silence is very difficult for you."* Allow this pupil to work elsewhere with support so the silence is not an issue. There may be a possibility that alternative arrangements can be made for assessments. Consider whether there is a possibility that this child can listen to some background noise by using headphones. Give the child an alternative to noise; a quiet toy that he can squeeze as an alternative. Spending prolonged periods at his desk might not be possible; allowing him to leave his desk periodically can help.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Initiate – there is more pressure because the silence eradicates some of the common practices for avoiding work. In some situations, planning and organising in relation to organising one's thinking and responses.	Reminding by a statement before the lesson. *"Remember we are going to try hard for you not to make any noise during this assessment."* Using graduated timers, work with the child on managing this for a set period, gradually increasing the period in class. Take this very slowly so that he experiences success. Make the expected time clear and do not be tempted to increase it rapidly because he is managing well – stick to the intended plan. If he does not manage, re-adjust your expectation, *" I can see you are having trouble managing five minutes. That's OK. We'll try 3 minutes tomorrow."*
As always, phraseology is important here – the pupil needs to know you understand that this is a genuine issue for him and that you are prepared to assist him with this. Although undoubtedly necessary at times, working in silence is unusual now that there is an emphasis on group and paired learning. Silence in the workplace is unusual and it is necessary for pupils to learn to concentrate when surrounded by a low level of noise. You might want to create some of your own noise within the class at times, for example starting the day with music and singing and providing carefully chosen music during the lesson. This can benefit the whole class as it creates a relaxed atmosphere and an environment where a variety of senses can be used to increase learning opportunities, although care needs to be taken to ensure the environment does not become too sensory overwhelming.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Unable to sit still

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
This child is constantly moving; he cannot stay in his seat during lessons, always finding an excuse to move around; he shuffles around in assemblies etc.	Possible anxiety about what is coming next. Frenetic behaviour can act as a barrier to feelings that might be overwhelming.	This could be part of A.D.H.D. behaviour. It could be due to sensory arousal. It is likely that it is based in anxiety – many of these children live in a constant state of anxiety, sometimes not even feeling the security that they will be returning to the same home after school. Moving can be a way to use up excess adrenaline, levels of which may be heightened due to early life experiences.	Accept this child's need to move and work with it. Support him in his placement within class or the school hall. Let him know that he needs to sit near an adult who can support him rather than as a punishment. Encourage the support of his peers by accepting that this is a difficulty for this child.	Behaviour inhibition – an inability to stop himself Possibly shift – a lack of security as to what is coming next	Try to alleviate any school anxieties that this child may have. Build lots of short physical breaks into the school day. Incorporate more kinaesthetic learning opportunities. Provide a 'Move and Sit' cushion which allows the child to move on his seat.

The other members of the class will accept that this child needs this intervention if it is presented to them as a difficulty. If the teacher is positive, children will follow this lead and may be incredibly supportive towards this child, even fetching the resource for him if he forgets. Any initial distraction that this may cause will disappear quickly as the whole class accepts the need. This is also a very positive learning opportunity for other children who can be helped to accept difference in all its facets.

Diet may play a part here. Although the school rarely has a direct influence over diet, curriculum coverage of nutrition can help to educate the child himself and consideration may be helpful at school parties etc.

Within school policy, snacks permitted at breaks may be issues that need to be addressed for the benefit of all pupils.

It might benefit the child if he is given 'permission' to move around in the class. He could be encouraged to show the teacher his work every 10 minutes or so thereby allowing the movement the child needs while maintaining class rules and boundaries. A timer that the child could use might provide a visual reminder of this strategy. A fiddle object may also allow the child to 'move' while sitting still thereby reducing disruption to the class as a whole.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour - Stealing

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Stealing – possibly not an item that is particularly wanted, possibly in spite of the child being able to acquire the object by different means, possibly even if she knows that the theft will be discovered.	Seeing an item or knowing of its existence and having the opportunity to steal Creating situations to give opportunities to steal.	Survival strategy – This child may have been deprived and neglected in her early history. She may have experienced the need to steal and hoard in order to survive. An inability to cope with boundaries. Possibly, an underlying belief that she was 'stolen' from her birth parents. Insecurity – This child may be feeling insecure because of her perception of the vulnerability of her present placement or because of her feelings of rejection and shame. Stealing gives her some control and power.	Avoid the possibility of this child being able to steal. Provide more supervision, and ensure there is no temptation. Sanctions need to be relevant to the crime, but one needs to ensure that the sanction does not further shame the child. The child needs to accept responsibility for her actions and to manage the consequences e.g. *"Taking ….. lets me know you don't feel good about yourself. Let me help you return …. and tidy up ….'s desk to help you feel better about yourself."*	Behaviour inhibition – delayed development so acts as a toddler – wanting and so taking. Self-monitor	If you know that this child has stolen, don't ask her if she has or why she has. She does not know why, and is feeling increased shame that she has not managed again. Intervene to create an environment where temptation is reduced. Role-play scenarios without shaming. Implement immediate, relevant consequences that address the balance within the classroom setting.

Stealing is considered rightly by many to be a serious misdemeanour and it creates anxieties that this will continue into adulthood. Some worry that there could be a genetic tendency to crime. We believe that careful management of the situation can help children through this. This child cannot help what she is doing and needs the support of all the adults in her life to help her. Being sad for her rather than angry will help her to see your empathy rather than your anger. There is a tendency to feel the need to show anger for the benefit of other members of the class, but this will only accentuate the immense feeling of shame this child is experiencing. She does, however, need to realise her responsibility and to experience a consequence for her actions. School policy may dictate the sanctions; however we would suggest, if possible, that the child is encouraged to return the item and do something to compensate the victim. This shows other members of the class that stealing is not acceptable without the need to shame the child.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Stranger familiarity

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
A readiness to trust unknown or unfamiliar adults – no sense of stranger/ danger. A tendency or willingness to travel home with other parents or strangers without his own parents' permission.	Visitors to school, school trips, carer not being there to meet him from school.	Safety issues - a lack of experience of boundaries, and therefore an inability to perceive danger or the need to keep 'safe'. Control – a need to demonstrate that he has control over his life. Rejection - a need to demonstrate to the current care-giver that he can manage without him/her. Retaliation – a need to pay the carer back for leaving him with other adults during the day. Adult acceptance – a history of moving from one carer to the next leading to a general acceptance that he can be cared for by anyone. Attention – a need for adult attention of any kind.	This child needs to be kept safe and so the environment needs to be adapted to enable this. Speak to him about the worry that his behaviour causes and the need for you to keep him safe. *"I know that when you were a baby, adults did not keep you safe. I need to help you learn how to keep safe. You need to practise keeping safe when we go out."* Or *"We are the adults in your life and we need to keep you safe, so when we go out of school, you will need to hold my hand/stay next to Mrs … all the time."* It needs to be conveyed that this is not a punishment but a preventative tactic. *"Mum tells me if you are to be collected by somebody else. If Mum hasn't told me this you must wait with me for Mum to collect you as Mum needs to know that you are safe."*	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control – no boundary for fear Self-monitor Planning and organising	This child needs the adults in his life to act as his external regulators. Verbalise the need to keep safe and involve him in considering tactics to keep himself safe. Talk through these repeatedly so that he can start internalising this, perhaps giving him a mantra that he can say to himself. Use photographs of known 'safe' adults and 'strangers' to allow him to practise who he 'knows' is safe. Incorporate some faces that he will recognise (e.g. celebrities) but with whom it would not be good to go unless his parents knew.
Children like these present Child Protection issues and so Risk Assessments may need to be completed. Home and school need to work together to ensure vulnerable times are covered. In some individual cases, police may need to be involved because of the vulnerability of the child. Some of these children can be very charming to strangers. These situations can be managed by saying "….. *is very friendly isn't he? We are helping him to figure out the important people in his life. I wonder if you could remind him that you are a stranger and he needs to keep his cuddles for mum and dad."*					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Inability to Cope with a Supply Teacher

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Acting out, dissociating or feeling 'ill'.	Absence of usual teacher	Rejection, loss and separation – This child may have real problems making attachments, and feels fiercely protective of any positive experiences with attachments. He may have experienced adults disappearing suddenly, not being there when he woke up, being removed from a placement without warning. He may have a history of being rejected and expects all the adults in his life to fit this criterion of rejecting him. His behaviour is his way of showing his fear and insecurity.	Have the care-giver provide a photograph or article from home to help him manage the day. Validate the child's feelings, e.g. "*I know you find it really hard when Miss X isn't here to teach you…*" Avoid the problem by placing the child in a familiar environment where he is comfortable, explaining this move as help rather than punishment *"I know you will feel safer with Mrs Y today as you know her well and I know you find it really hard to focus well when you do not know the teacher."*	Shift Emotional control	Give advance warning, and involve the carer to reinforce the warning at home prior to arrival at school. Validate his feelings. Try to provide extra support with a known teaching assistant.
This child's security can be shattered if he walks into the classroom and his usual teacher or teaching assistant is not there. The structure and predictability he craves and needs has disappeared, and he immediately feels insecure and possibly unsafe. Many children feel unsettled with a supply teacher. A photograph of the usual teacher in the classroom may be beneficial. This may also be helpful in classes taught by job-sharing teachers where you could have a photograph of both teachers with the days they teach. Reinforce with a verbal reminder – '*Miss X is here on Mondays and Tuesdays, Miss Y on Wednesdays, Thursdays and Fridays. Today is ……..*'					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Swearing

Possible behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Swearing or using offensive language – this can be in the context of verbally abusing another individual or as an expletive following or accompanying an event or action.	Possibly another pupil or adult behaving or speaking in a manner that the pupil perceives as threatening. Possibly an exciting or emotional event. Possibly because the child knows that this will get teacher attention.	Control – a perception that the behaviour is unacceptable with predictable consequences. Shame – she feels unworthy, therefore will act and speak accordingly. Familiarity - a history of acceptance of inappropriate language in her birth home. This may have been on a constant, everyday basis, and may have been aimed at the child in her early formative years. The child may have experienced or witnessed abusive behaviour and may have the perception that this language accompanies adrenaline-flowing events or actions. Lack of boundaries.	Validating the pupil's feelings – *"I can see that you were really furious/worried/ ashamed …."* *"I guess you may have learnt this language when you were younger. Perhaps I can help you be angry in another way"* *"I've heard you say --- when you kicked the ball and I think this is a word you use when you are excited. Let's think together of a better way to show your excitement."* Consequences need to be ones that do not exacerbate the shame this pupil is already feeling.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control	Looking at the triggers and providing alternative scenarios. If the swearing is linked to retaliation, role-play alternative action. Agree and practise a 'mantra' until this becomes internalised. If the swearing is linked to actions e.g. swearing when one scores a goal, agree appropriate expressions. If the ethos of the team is caring and supportive, employ agreed team reactions.
Rightly, students need to know that it is unacceptable to use swearing or offensive language towards others, whether fellow students or adults. However, not all children have been brought up in an environment with these values. They may never have experienced consideration and respect, and need to be taught these by example and guidance just as a toddler is taught within a loving family.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – 'Switching off'

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Switching off or dissociating	Possibly a challenging situation. Possibly a topic, word, smell, facial expression, body movement, texture, sound, taste etc. that evokes a memory.	Self-protection – this child may have learnt this behaviour at an early age as a means of survival. The primal and instinctive reactions of 'flight, fight or freeze' may have been the reason that this child is still alive. Control – 'shutting down' feels the only way the child can keep control of his life. Shame – this child may be filled with immense shame about what has happened in the past and this is easily reactivated.	This child needs to learn to trust to be able to overcome this primal instinct. This will not be easy and this is not a quick fix problem. However, a consistently calm and empathic approach will support him. He needs to be brought back to the lesson quietly and unobtrusively so that his shame is not compounded. An agreed code-word or signal may help here. Validation of his dilemma e.g. "*I can see that sometimes you start thinking about something else instead of the lesson. Let's see if we can find a way to help you focus on the lesson.*" or *"I can see you are thinking about something sad right now. Would you like to sit on the cushions in the book corner and Mrs S will come and sit with you."*	Emotional control – dissociating is the only way this child can control his emotions when the adrenaline and cortisol start flowing. Monitor – the child may not have learnt to monitor settings realistically. Shift – he may be unable to move away from one thought to another. Initiate – he may be unable to start a task independently.	Although this child probably does not 'act out' and may not be particularly disruptive in class, he does need adult support to enable him to cope. He needs an external modulator to help him to cope with his emotions, just like a toddler. Validating his feelings and talking through them may help here. Supporting him at the start and end of activities, and differentiating work and questions may lessen the challenge enough for him to feel he will be successful.
Monitoring this child's behaviours in a log over a period of time may give vital clues of the triggers causing the dissociation. If he cannot cope with certain challenges, then these need to be adapted so that he can be successful more easily. Any identified triggers relating to unpleasant memories may be best avoided if possible, as he really needs to be in the security of his care-givers to learn to manage these well. Communication with his care-givers is important here. Gently placing a hand on this child's shoulder or arm may bring him back to the present; however you will have to ensure that this does not lead to further traumatisation of the child and that it is permitted in the school policy.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Tantrums

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Acting out, tantrums, possible aggression or violence.	Disappointment, a perception of unfairness, a challenging or shaming situation, a feeling of fear or being threatened, feeling a failure. Possibly a topic, word, smell, facial expression, body movement, texture, sound, taste etc. that evokes a memory.	The instinctive survival behaviours of flight, fight or freeze. Fighting could have been this child's defence tactic. Insecurity – this child has not established or internalised a sense of safety within this setting possibly due to her earlier experiences of unsafe surroundings and adults. Shame – she may constantly live under the shadow of shame. She may feel she is 'rubbish' and so acts accordingly. Control – a need to have control over others, either by violence or by exhibiting behaviours that cannot be controlled by others.	Monitoring possible volatile settings with a view to intervening before the situation develops. Validation of the child's feelings – *"I know you are very angry."* *"I can see you panic when you think you cannot manage your work."* This child needs to feel she can succeed. If she goes out at playtime and is brought in if she has a tantrum she will have a sense of failure. If she goes out to play for the last 5 minutes without a tantrum she will experience success.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Self-monitor	Intervention is better than addressing the behaviour afterwards. If the pupil finds playtimes or unstructured times challenging, provide an alternative e.g. a club or job. Allow the pupil to leave the setting at the first sign of temper, by providing a safe haven, preferably with an adult close by so the child feels safe. Try role-play scenarios and cognitive anger-management techniques, helping her to recognise the signs that lead to the tantrums and suggesting alternative ways to demonstrate her anger or fear. Support her in saying a mantra to herself to help her to cope.

This child's emotional development may well be similar to the level of a toddler's, hence behaviour normally associated with 'the terrible twos'. As a toddler, she needs the external regulator to act as a role model and to guide and support her. Although there may be a necessity to isolate the child from her peers for their protection, 'time-out' acts as another rejection and evacuating the class could trigger memories of neglect or being isolated before being abused. You therefore need to work out a plan in advance to manage the child's behaviour and your response. Letting the child know what to expect in advance should reduce feelings of rejection and also gives the child the clear message that you can handle her behaviour. This is crucial as these children feel out of control and uncontrollable. They need to experience adults being in caring control.

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